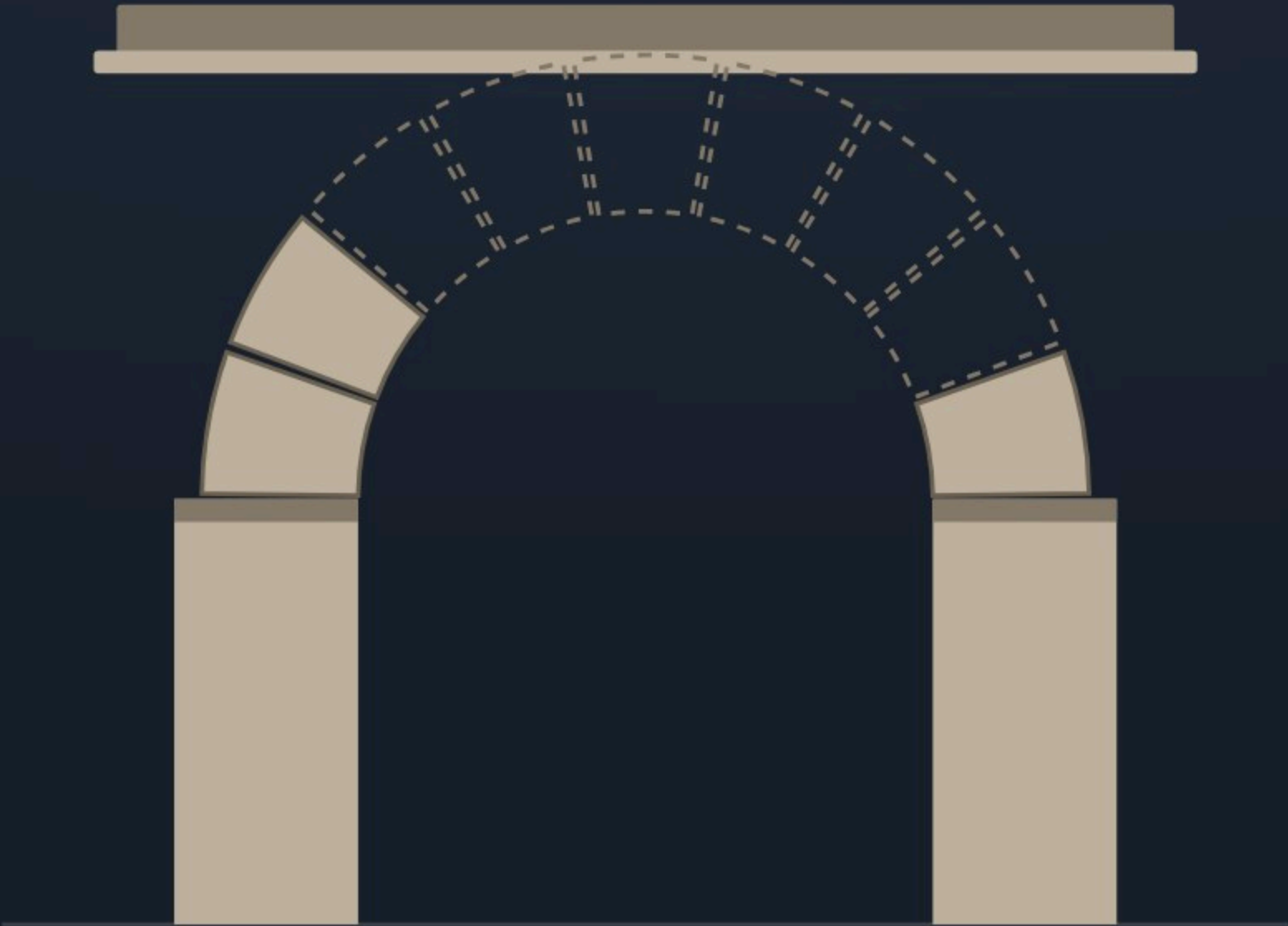




No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



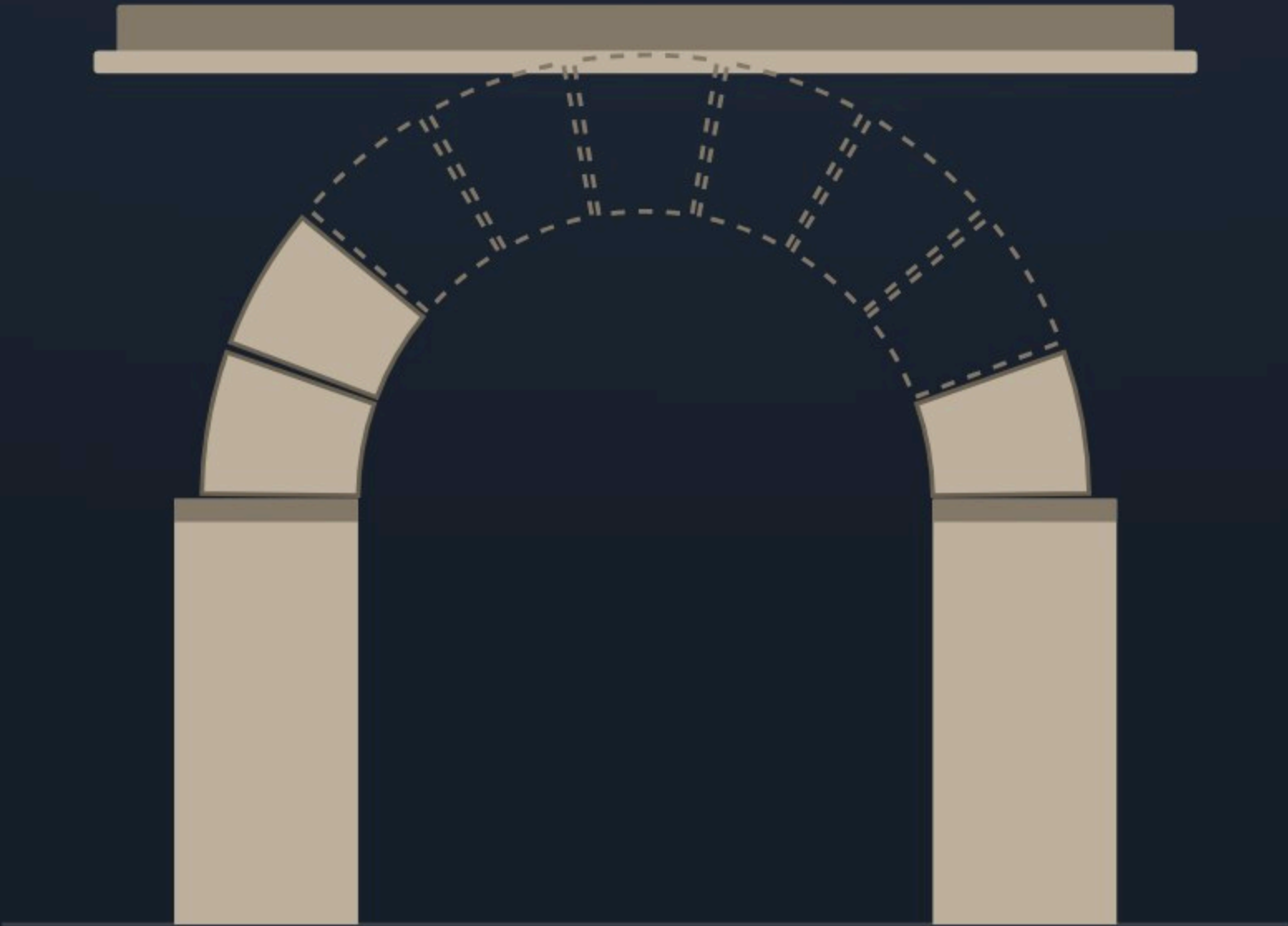
Marta

TRUST BUILDS PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY. HOW DO LEADERS BUILD TRUST?

- Ask
- Listen
- Act
- Tell

Every leader is told: **listen.**

Next →



No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



Marta

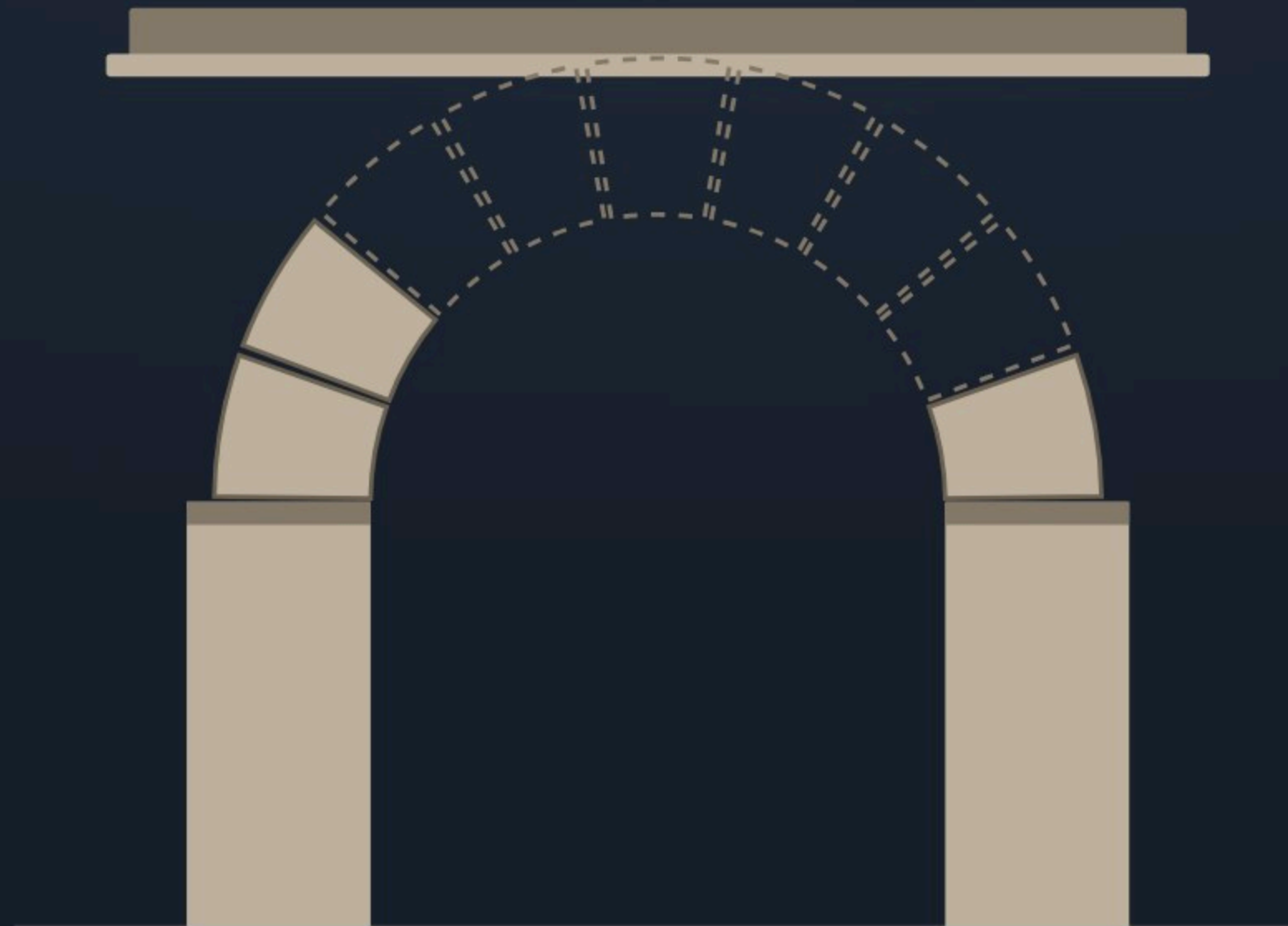
TRUST BUILDS PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY. HOW DO LEADERS BUILD TRUST?

Ask Listen Act Tell

Every leader is told: listen.  
But some people don't  
speak unless you **ask**.

“The questions we ask influence what people notice, discuss, and believe is possible.” · Appreciative Inquiry

Next →



No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



Marta

TRUST BUILDS PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY. HOW DO LEADERS BUILD TRUST?

Ask

Listen

Act

**Tell**

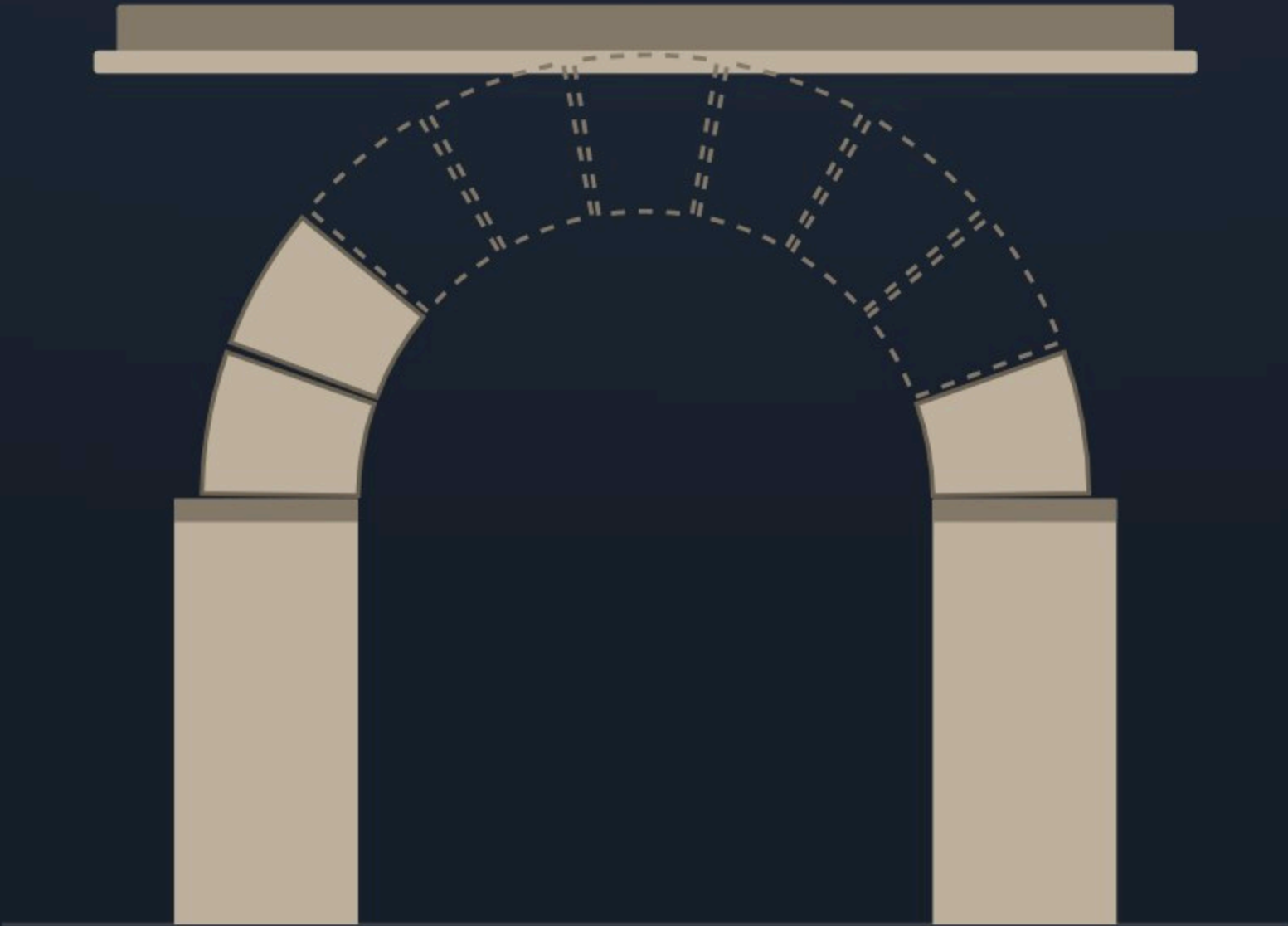
Every leader is told: listen.  
But some people don't  
speak unless you ask.

And if you don't **act** and **tell**,  
they never speak again.

“Asking without acting erodes trust faster than not asking at all.”

· Workplace Wellbeing Practices

Next →



No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



Marta

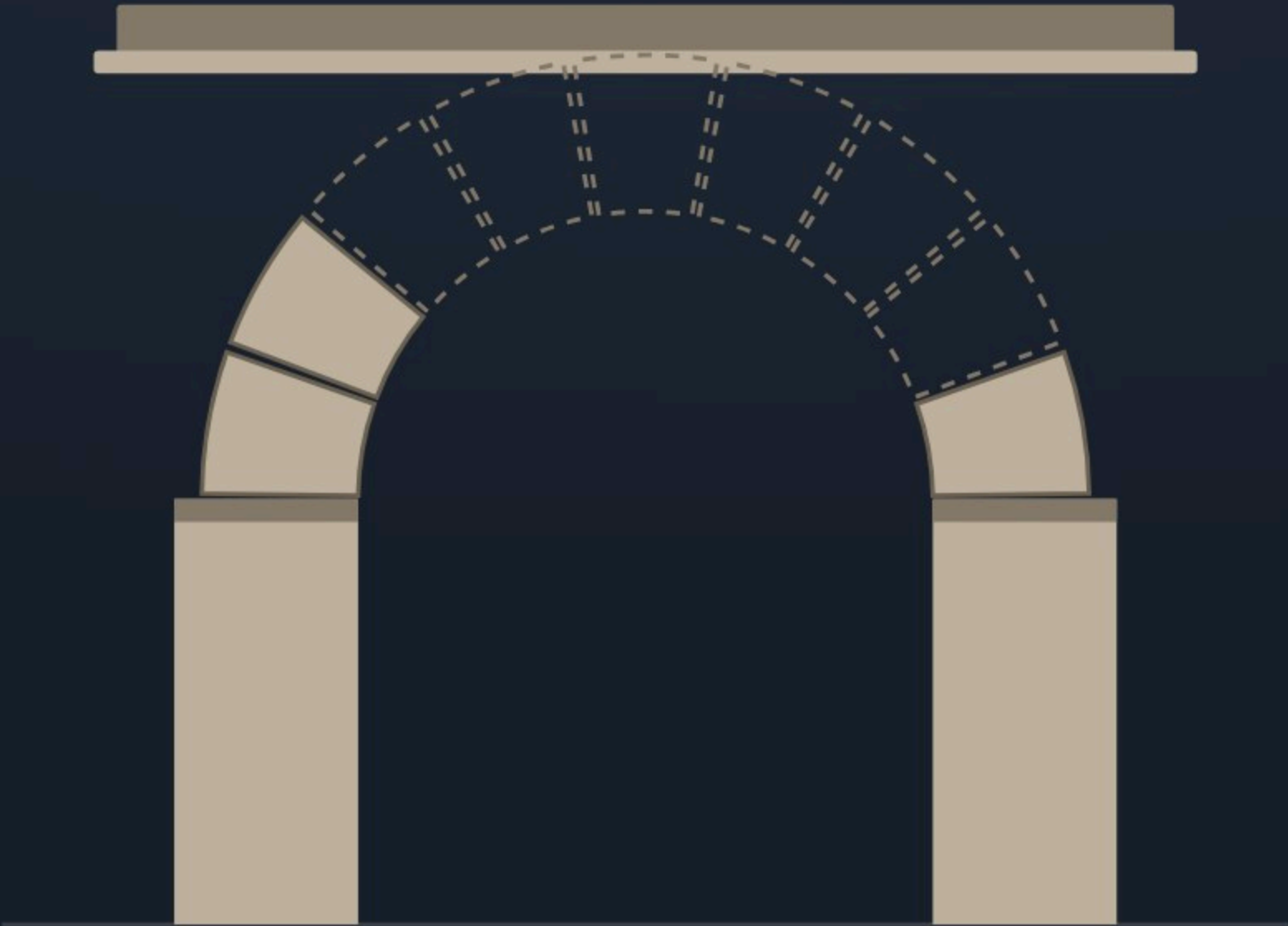
A GAME ABOUT ACTING ON FEEDBACK

# Build the Aqueduct

Segovia's aqueduct has stood for almost 2,000 years without mortar. Every stone carries the next one.

- 3** sliding door moments. You ask, your team answers.
- 4** ways to react. The room votes with 1–4 fingers.
- 9** stones complete the arch.

Start



No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



Marta

**ROUND 1 OF 3 · SLIDING DOOR: CHALLENGING THE STATUS QUO · VOTE NOW**

*In your 1:1 you ask Marta: “What should I do differently?”*

MARTA · SENIOR ENGINEER

**I don't feel I can disagree with you in meetings. You've decided before we talk.**

**1 Defend**

“I always ask for input. People should speak up more.”

**2 Listen only**

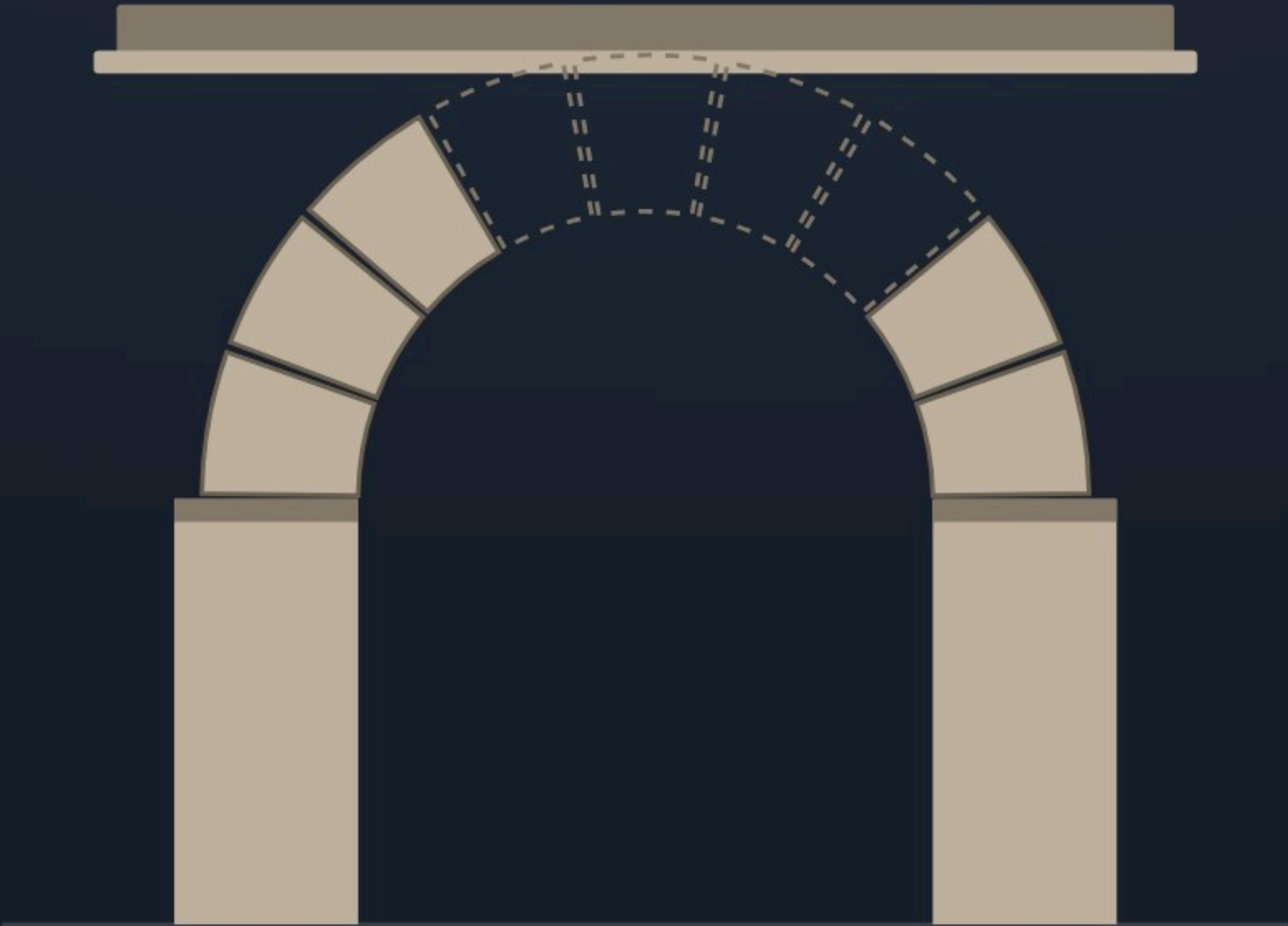
“Thanks, really good point.” Nothing changes.

**3 Act, don't tell**

Ask for views before giving yours. Don't mention it.

**4 Act and tell**

Change how you run meetings. Tell the team Marta raised it.



No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



Marta

ROUND 1 · THE ROOM CHOSE 4

**1 Defend**  
“I always ask for input. People should speak up more.”

**2 Listen only**  
“Thanks, really good point.” Nothing changes.

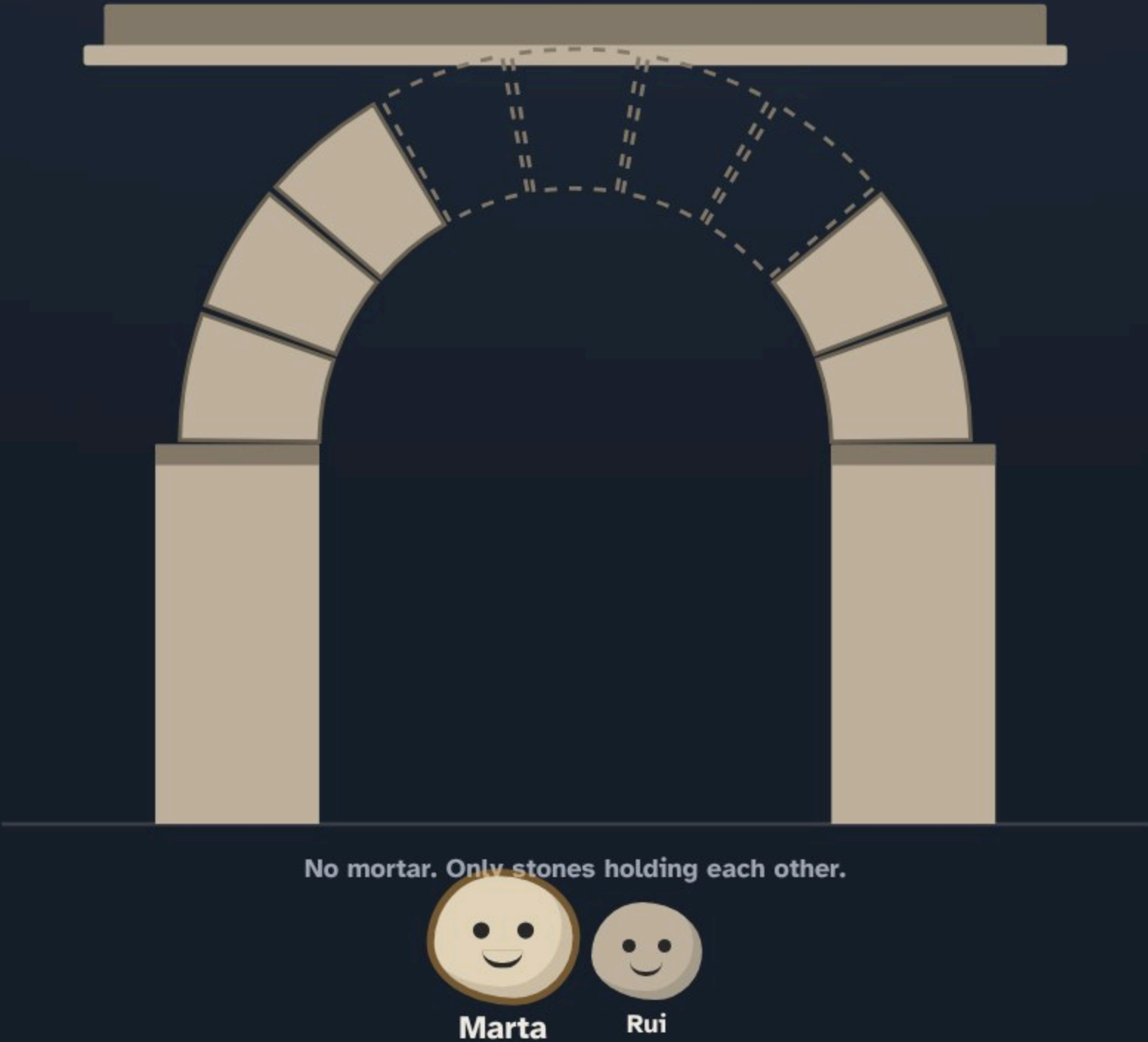
**3 Act, don't tell**  
Ask for views before giving yours. Don't mention it.

**4 Act and tell**  
Change how you run meetings. Tell the team Marta raised it.

+2 stones

Marta sees her voice changed something. Two stones.

Two weeks later →



**Two weeks later.** Marta disagrees with you in a meeting. That's the point.

**ROUND 2 OF 3 · SLIDING DOOR: SHARING AN IDEA · VOTE NOW**

*In the retro you ask the team: "What slows us down?"*

RUI · DESIGN ENGINEER

**Our daily stand-up runs 40 minutes. It eats my best focus time.**

**1 Defend**

"Alignment prevents rework. The numbers say we need it."

**2 Listen only**

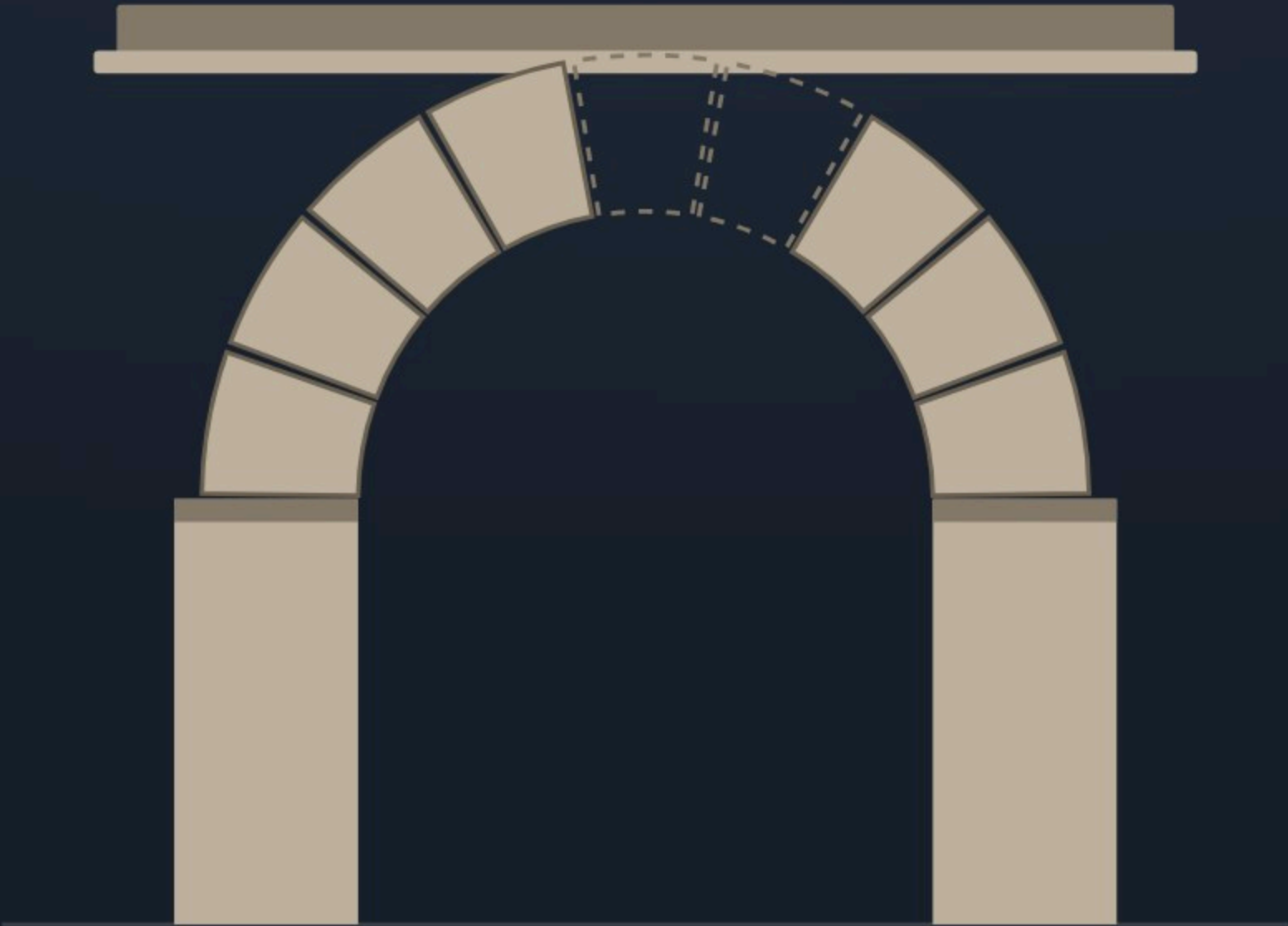
"Fair. Let's look at it at some point."

**3 Act, don't tell**

Cut it to 15 minutes. No explanation.

**4 Act and tell**

Cut to 15 minutes. "Rui flagged this. Tell me in two weeks if it works."



No mortar. Only stones holding each other.



Marta

Rui

**ROUND 2 · THE ROOM CHOSE 4**

**1** **Defend**

“Alignment prevents rework. The numbers say we need it.”

**2** **Listen only**

“Fair. Let’s look at it at some point.”

**3** **Act, don’t tell**

Cut it to 15 minutes. No explanation.

**4** **Act and tell**

Cut to 15 minutes. “Rui flagged this. Tell me in two weeks if it works.”

+2 stones

**Rui learns feedback is safe and useful. So does everyone watching.**

Two weeks later →



**Two weeks later.** Jonas and Lea join. They see feedback lead somewhere, and speak up from day one.

**ROUND 3 OF 3 · SLIDING DOOR: ADMITTING A MISTAKE · VOTE NOW**

*You ask Priya: “Is there anything you've been holding back?”*

**PRIYA · GRADUATE ENGINEER**

**I made a mistake on the drawings last week. I was afraid to tell you.**

**1 Defend**  
“That should have been caught. Who checked it?”

**2 Listen only**  
“OK, thanks for telling me.”

**3 Act, don't tell**  
Fix the review step. Keep it between you.

**4 Act and tell**  
Thank her in front of the team, fix the review step, report back.



ROUND 3 • THE ROOM CHOSE 4

**1 Defend**  
"That should have been caught. Who checked it?"

**2 Listen only**  
"OK, thanks for telling me."

**3 Act, don't tell**  
Fix the review step. Keep it between you.

**4 Act and tell**  
Thank her in front of the team, fix the review step, report back.

+3 stones • others joined in

Admitting a mistake just became the normal thing to do here.

See the arch →



9 OF 9 STONES

# The arch stands.

- Ask 3/3
- Listen 3/3
- Act 3/3
- Tell 3/3**

People don't speak if you don't ask. They stop speaking if you don't act and tell.

“Trust is built in very small moments.” · Brené Brown, in Psychological Safety

**This week** Name one person. Ask what you should change. Act on one thing. Then tell them what changed.

Play again



6 OF 9 STONES

# The arch can't close.

Ask 3/3

Listen 3/3

Act 3/3

Tell 0/3

People don't speak if you don't ask. They stop speaking if you don't act and tell.

“Trust is built in very small moments.” · Brené Brown, in Psychological Safety

**This week** Name one person. Ask what you should change. Act on one thing. Then tell them what changed.

Play again